AquaStack

A modular water filter.

Ava Akkad, Grady Allen, Temuulen Altankhuyag, Burton Harbrook, Charlotte Kampfmann, Hailey Linden, Nicholas Martin, Jack Vlacich



AquaStack

A modular water filter.

The Problem With Traditional Filters

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The Problem

Over **2.2 billion people** worldwide lack access to safely managed drinking water. Existing filtration options are **single-purpose, non-portable**, and **unable to adapt** to different contaminants or water sources, leaving users to choose between cost, convenience, and effectiveness.

The Solution

AquaStack is a **modular water filtration device** featuring **stackable rings**, each designed to **target specific contaminants**. The device fits most faucets and outdoor spigots, offering users an easy-to-install, clean, and replaceable solution for safe water anywhere.



Mission & Vision

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A modular water filter.

Mission

To provide **clean, safe, and affordable water** to everyone, everywhere through **customizable** and **easy-to-use** modular filtration technology.

Vision

To become a **global leader in accessible water innovation**, by creating **modular solutions** that make clean water a universal standard.



Potential Customers

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International Households



10% CAGR

- Sub-Saharan Africa
- Latin America
- Asia Pacific

Customers purchase directly from our website

Outdoor Recreation Retailers



8% CAGR

REI, Bass Pro Shops, & Sportsman's Guide

Customers purchase through U.S. based retailers

Outdoor Enthusiasts



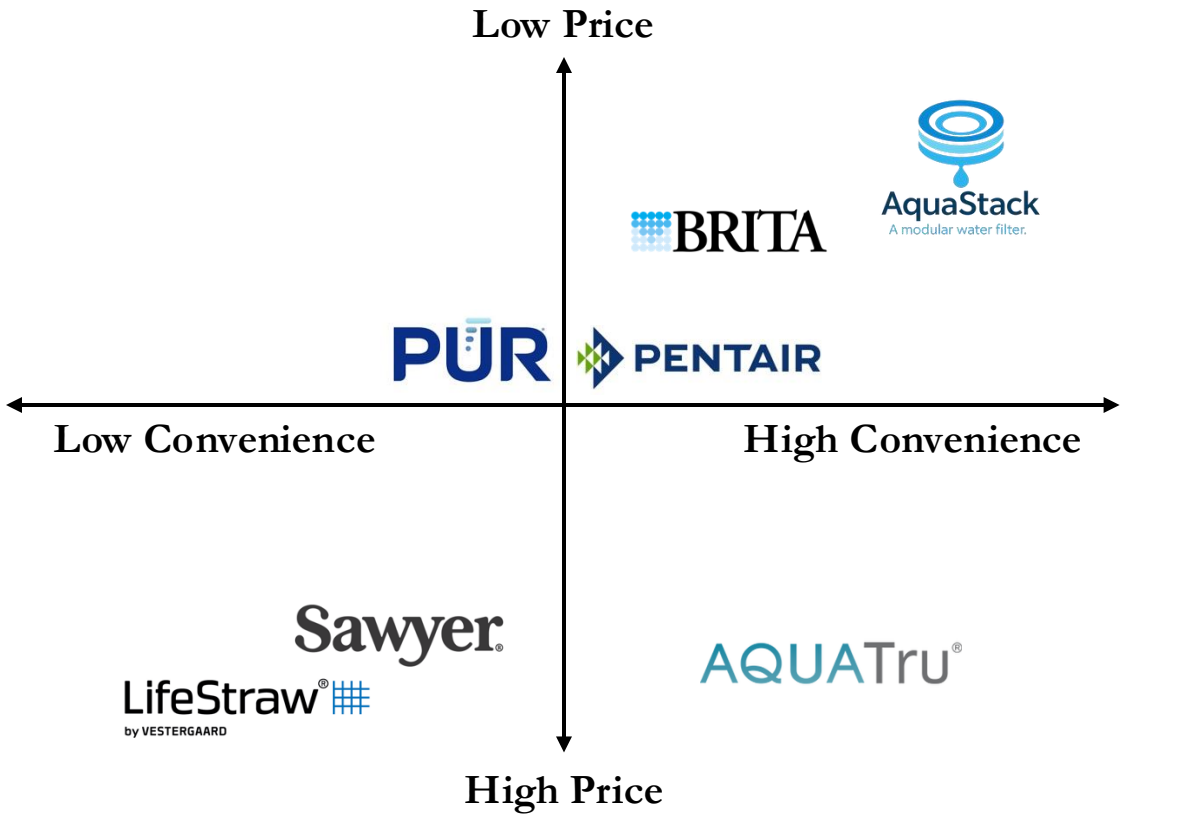
8.8% CAGR

Campers, Backpackers, Hikers, & Travelers

Customers purchase directly from our website & through U.S. based retailers

Positioning

Water Filtration Perceptual Map



Positioning

AquaStack is a **low-cost**, **high-impact** modular water filter combining advanced, **customizable filtration** with effortless **convenience**, leading in both affordability and convenience.

Global Impact

For every AquaStack purchased, **10¢ is donated to UNICEF** to help provide clean, safe drinking water to underserved communities worldwide.

Marketing Mix

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Product

- **Modular** 3-ring water filter targeting
  - taste, metals, and bacteria
- **Adaptable** faucet attachment for
  - home or travel use
- **Affordable**, sustainable, and
  - customizable design

Place

- Sold on **our website** and **major outdoor retailers** (REI, Bass Pro, etc.)
- Manufactured in **Austin, TX**
- **International reach** to U.S. and regions lacking safe water sources

Marketing Mix

Price

- **$20** per main filter, **$15** per 3-ring replacement pack
- **Competitive pricing** vs. Brita and PUR; high value-to-cost ratio
- Supports **affordability** and **brand loyalty** through repeat sales

Promotion

- **Marketing campaigns** highlighting modularity, sustainability, and social impact
- Partnerships with environmental organizations and **UNICEF** (**10¢ per sale** donated)
- Targeted outreach to outdoor and **international consumer segments**

Critical Resources

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Ultrasonic Welder



Branson 2000X Series Ultrasonic Welder
$35,000

Uses

- Seal filter into plastic mold and plastic onto top of filter

SCARA Robot



Epson G6 SCARA Robot
$10,000

Uses

- Place membrane into plastic molds

Auger Filler



All-Fill B/600 Auger Filler
$26,750

Uses

- Fill mold with activated carbon and ion exchange resin

Titan Atlas T4



Titan Atlas T4
$140,000

Uses

- Auto-boxing machine

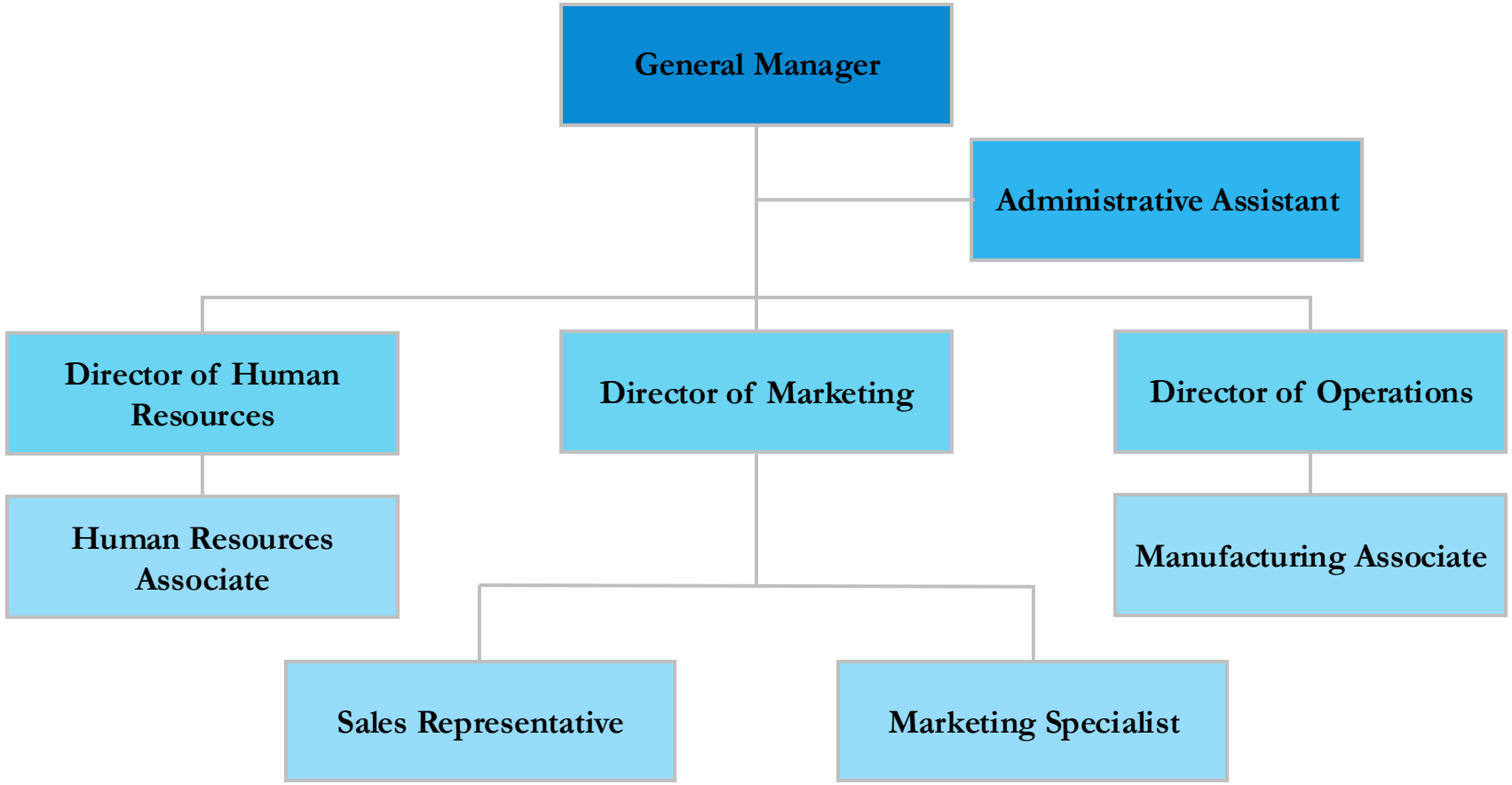
Quality and Operational Advantage

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Dimension of Quality	Importance	Assurance	Operational Advantage
Reliability	Customers expect a product that will consistently remove contaminants without leaks, clogs, or any failures.	Durability tests and premium materials	Little to no maintenance and strengthens brand loyalty
Special Features	Provides advanced filtration by addressing multiple types of contaminants.	Functionality tests and live demonstrations	Unique attributes gives competitive advantage
Convenience	Simple installation, removal, and maintenance to ensure versatility and ease of use.	Stress tests and application tests	Easy installation and maintenance
Performance	Customers expect safe, clean, and great-tasting water.	Six Sigma and lab tests	Reduces customer complaints and returns

Organizational Structure

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Motivation

We prioritize employee well-being and success through a **supportive**, **flexible** work environment. We accommodate individual needs, **celebrate achievements** with monthly recognition and appreciation events, and host holiday gatherings to **build connection**, **reduce stress**, and foster a **positive culture**.

Incentives

Sales reps can earn up to **$50K** in **commissions**, and directors receive **performance-based bonuses**.

Sources of Capital

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Sources of Capital

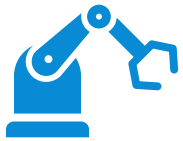
Founder Capital
$1,200,000

SBA Loan
$600,000

Total Sourced: $1,800,000

Deployment of Capital

Machinery



$273,500

Materials



$457,297

Direct Labor



$526,232

Rent



$117,600

Misc.

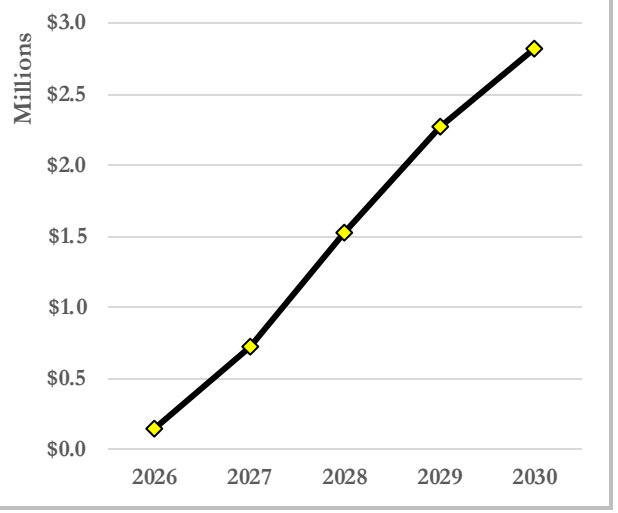
Plastic Mold, Accounting, Website Development, Licensing, R&D

$370,614

Financial Performance

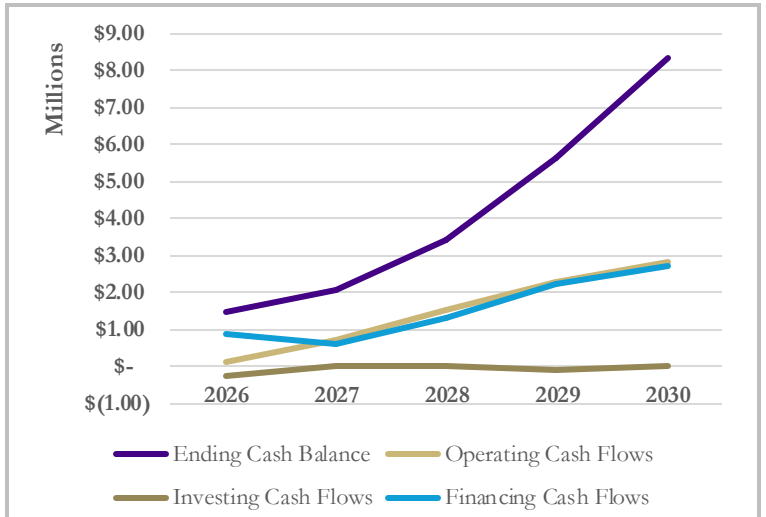
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Net Income



AquaStack **breaks even** in 2026, then shows **steady profit growth** through 2030, driven by **rising revenue** and **efficiency gains**

Cash Flow Breakdown



Rising operating cash and cash reserves show **strong growth** and **stability**, while negative investing cash reflects **minimal financing** needs.

Benchmark

Year	Gross Profit Margin	Debt/Equity	Operating Cycle
2026	68.32	0.42	101.7
2027	68.21	0.25	101.37
2028	72.24	0.19	115.07
2029	73.92	0.07	122.04
2030	74.46	0.04	124.48
Industry Average	47.59	0.74	194.5

AquaStack consistently outperforms industry benchmarks. Our strong gross profit margins highlight **superior efficiency** and **pricing power**, while a lower debt-to-equity ratio reflects **financial stability** and **minimal reliance on borrowing**. Additionally, a shorter operating cycle demonstrates our ability to **convert sales into cash faster**, supporting **healthy liquidity** and **sustained growth**.

Valuation Estimate

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Pentair Valuation (2024 Stats)

PENTAIR

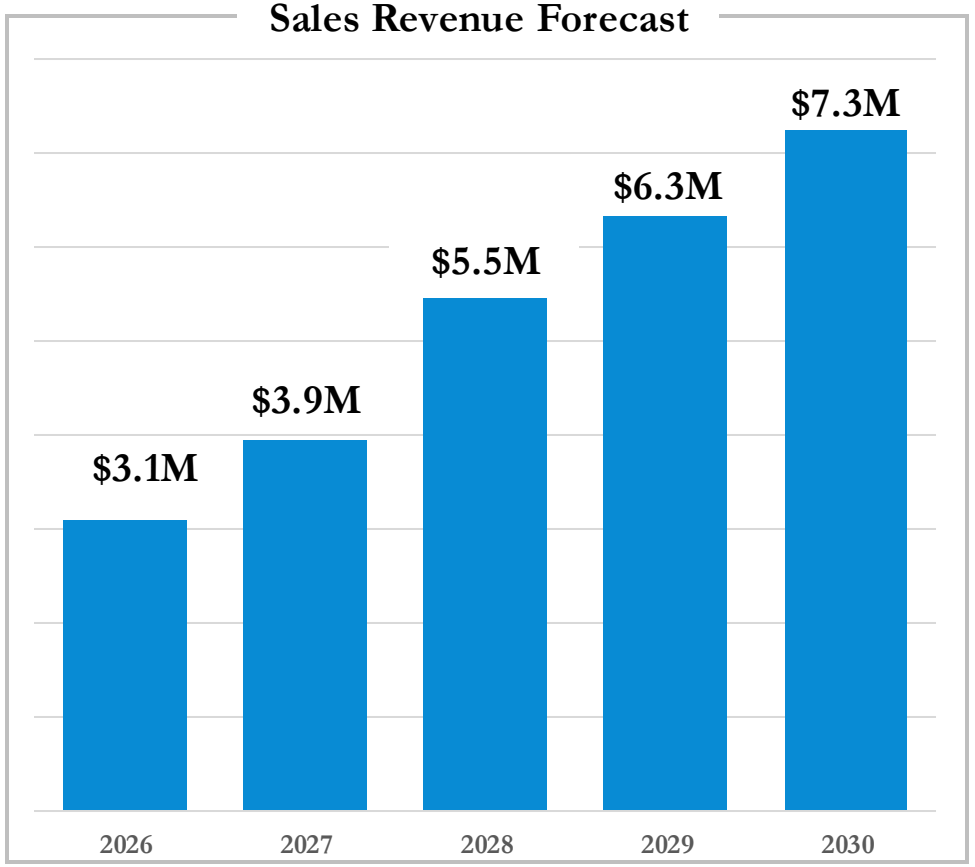
$16.71B	$4.08B	4.096
Market Cap	*Total Revenue*	*P/S Ratio*

7.3M *AquaStack Total Revenue* **x** **4.096** *Pentair P/S Ratio*

$30,045,663.23

AquaStack Valuation

AquaStack Revenue



Questions?



Ava Akkad



Grady Allen



Temuulen Altankhuyag



Burton Harbrook



Charlotte Kampfmann



Hailey Linden



Nicholas Martin



Jack Vlacich

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Appendix 1: Financial Statements

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	Date Ending 2026	%	Date Ending 2027	%	Date Ending 2028	%	Date Ending 2029	%	Date Ending 2030	%
Sales Revenue	$3,104,763	100.00%	$3,949,603	100.00%	$5,471,662	100.00%	$6,333,502	100.00%	$ 7,335,367	100.00%
Materials Cost	$ 457,297	14.73%	$ 597,764	15.13%	$ 861,070	15.74%	$ 993,869	15.69%	$ 1,149,665	15.67%
Direct Labor Cost	$ 526,232	16.95%	$ 657,790	16.65%	$ 657,790	12.02%	$ 657,790	10.39%	$ 723,569	9.86%
Total Cost of Goods Sold	983,529	31.68%	1,255,554	31.79%	1,518,860	27.76%	1,651,659	26.08%	1,873,234	25.54%
Gross Profit	$2,121,234		$2,694,049		$3,952,802		$4,681,843		$ 5,462,133	
Operating Expenses										
Indirect Labor Cost	$ 934,187	30.09%	$ 934,187	23.65%	$1,120,519	20.48%	$1,120,519	17.69%	$ 1,306,851	17.82%
Advertising and Promotion Expense	496,762	16.00%	552,944	14.00%	693,581	12.68%	633,350	10.00%	586,829	8.00%
Rent Expense	117,600	3.79%	117,600	2.98%	117,600	2.15%	117,600	1.86%	117,600	1.60%
Research and Development Expense	93,143	3.00%	118,488	3.00%	164,150	3.00%	190,005	3.00%	220,061	3.00%
Commissions Expense	40,000	1.29%	40,000	1.01%	80,000	1.46%	80,000	1.26%	120,000	1.64%
General Insurance Expense	18,000	0.58%	22,000	0.56%	32,000	0.58%	36,000	0.57%	41,000	0.56%
Travel, Meals, and Entertainment	19,000	0.61%	19,000	0.48%	19,000	0.35%	19,000	0.30%	19,000	0.26%
Website Expense	48,000	1.55%	18,000	0.46%	18,000	0.33%	18,000	0.28%	18,000	0.25%
Licenses	300	0.01%	300	0.01%	300	0.01%	300	0.00%	300	0.00%
Accounting Expense	46,571	1.50%	59,244	1.50%	82,075	1.50%	95,003	1.50%	110,031	1.50%
Depreciation Expense	16,487	0.53%	16,487	0.42%	16,487	0.30%	20,487	0.32%	20,487	0.28%
Plastic Mold Expense	65,000	2.09%	-	0.00%	-	0.00%	-	0.00%	-	0.00%
Charity (10c per unit sold)	16,309	0.53%	21,231	0.54%	30,396	0.56%	35,097	0.55%	40,604	0.55%
Total Operating Expenses	$1,911,359		$1,919,481		$2,374,108		$2,365,361		$ 2,600,763	
Earnings Before Interest and Taxes	$ 209,875		$ 774,568		$1,578,695		$2,316,482		$ 2,861,370	
Interest Expense	60,000		56,235		52,094		47,539		42,528	
Earnings Before Taxes	$ 149,875		$ 718,333		$1,526,601		$2,268,943		$ 2,818,842	
Income Tax Expense	-		-		-		-		-	
Net Income (Loss)	$ 149,875		$ 718,333		$1,526,601		$2,268,943		$ 2,818,842	
Operating Cash Flow	$ 226,362		$ 791,055		$ 1,595,182		$ 2,336,969		$ 2,881,857	
Free Cash Flow	$ (142,138)		$ 422,555		$ 1,156,682		$ 1,898,469		$ 2,443,357	

Statement of Retained Earnings					
Beginning Balance of Retained Earnings	$ -	$ 149,875	$ 868,208	$2,394,809	$ 4,663,752
Net Income (Loss)	149,875	718,333	1,526,601	2,268,943	2,818,842
Dividends to Stockholders	-	-	-	-	-
Ending Retained Earnings	$ 149,875	$ 868,208	$2,394,809	$4,663,752	$ 7,482,594

Pro Forma Balance Sheet	As of Inception Date	%	Date Ending 2026	%	Date Ending 2027	%	Date Ending 2028	%	Date Ending 2029	%	Date Ending 2030	%
	Common Size (as a percent of total assets)										Key: Input Field, Build Formula	
ASSETS												
Current Assets												
Cash and Cash Equivalents	$ 600,000		$1,458,972		$2,091,894		$3,416,334		5,627,711		8,328,573	
Accounts Receivable	-		59,543		75,746		104,936		121,464		140,678	
Inventory	-		255,186		324,625		449,726		520,562		602,907	
Total Current Assets	$ 600,000		$1,773,701		$2,492,265		$3,970,996		$6,269,737		$9,072,158	
Fixed (Long-Term) Assets												
Machinery and Equipment	-		273,500		273,500		343,500		343,500		343,500	
Total Gross Fixed Assets	$ -		$ 273,500		$ 273,500		$ 343,500		$ 343,500		$ 343,500	
Less: Accumulated Depreciation	-		16,487		32,974		49,461		69,948		90,435	
Net Fixed Assets	$ -		$ 257,013		$ 240,526		$ 294,039		$ 273,552		$ 253,065	
Total Assets	$ 600,000		$2,030,714		$2,732,791		$4,265,035		$6,543,289		$9,325,223	
LIABILITIES AND STOCKHOLDERS' EQUITY												
Liabilities												
Current Liabilities												
Accounts Payable	-		24,669		41,000		56,442		135,753		153,964	
Accrued Labor Costs	-		56,170		61,230		92,844		68,397		63,385	
Current Maturity of LT Debt			37,647		41,412		45,553		50,108		55,119	
Total Current Liabilities	$ -		$ 118,486		$ 143,642		$ 194,839		$ 254,258		$ 272,468	
Long-Term Liabilities												
LT Debt Less Current Maturities	$ 600,000		$ 562,353		$ 520,941		$ 475,388		$ 425,280		$ 370,161	
Total Liabilities	$ 600,000		$ 680,839		$ 664,583		$ 670,227		$ 679,538		$ 642,629	
STOCKHOLDER'S EQUITY												
Common Stock			1,200,000		1,200,000		1,200,000		1,200,000		1,200,000	
Retained Earnings	0		149,875		868,208		2,394,809		4,663,752		7,482,594	
Total Stockholders' Equity			$1,349,875		$2,068,208		$3,594,809		$5,863,752		$8,682,594	
Total Liabilities and Stockholders' Equity	$ 600,000		$2,030,714		$2,732,791		$4,265,035		$6,543,289		$9,325,223	

Appendix

Appendix 1: Financial Statements (cont.)

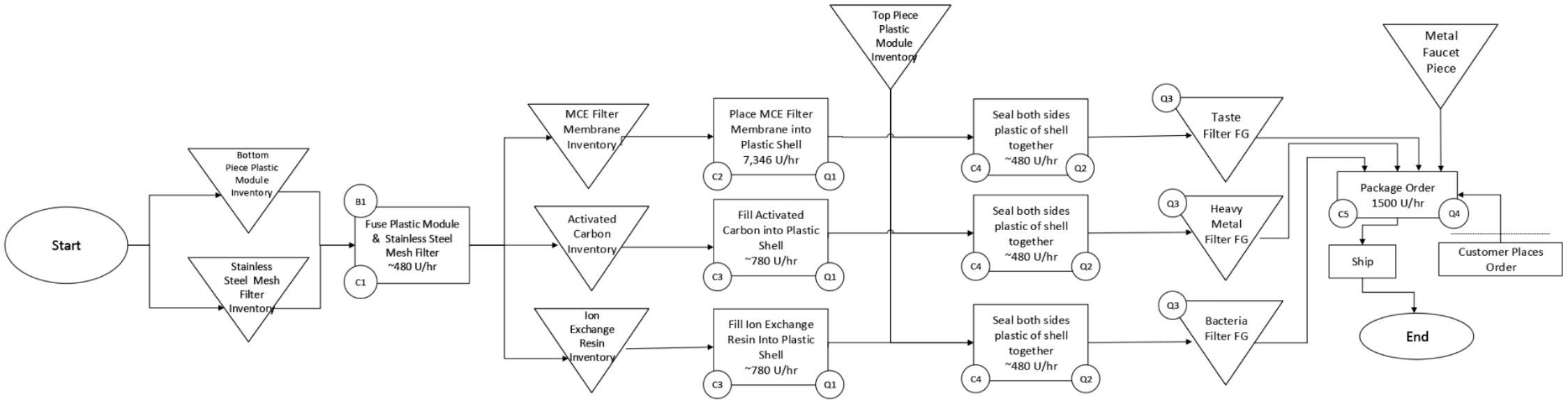
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Pro Forma Statement of Cash Flows	As of Inception Date	Date Ending 2026	Date Ending 2027	Date Ending 2028	Date Ending 2029	Date Ending 2030
						Key: Input Field / Build Formula
Cash Flows From (For) Operations						
Net Income	$ -	$ 149,875	$ 718,333	$ 1,526,601	$ 2,268,944	$ 2,818,842
Depreciation	-	16,487	16,487	16,487	20,487	20,487
Changes in Current Assets						
Increase in Accounts Receivable	-	59,543	16,203	29,190	16,528	19,214
Increase in Inventories	-	255,186	69,439	125,101	70,836	82,345
Changes in Current Liabilities						
Increase in Accounts Payable	-	62,316	20,096	(48,251)	153,865	18,211
Increase in Accrued Labor Costs	-	56,170	5,060	29,447	(24,447)	-
Net Cash Flow From (For) Operating	$ -	$ (29,881)	$ 674,334	$ 1,369,993	$ 2,331,485	$ 2,755,981
Cash Flow (For) From Investing Activities						
Fixed Asset Purchases/Sales		(273,500)	-	-	(70,000)	-
Net Cash Flow (For) From Investing	$ -	$ (273,500)	$ -	$ -	$ (70,000)	$ -
Cash Flow From (For) Financing Activities						
Issuance of Common Stock		$ 1,200,000	$ -	$ -	$ -	$ -
Long Term Debt Borrowings/Repayments	600,000	$ (37,647)	(41,412)	(45,553)	(50,108)	(55,119)
Dividends Paid to Stockholders	-	-	-	-	-	-
Net Cash Flows From (For) Financing	$ 600,000	$ 1,162,353	$ (41,412)	$ (45,553)	$ (50,108)	$ (55,119)
Net Change in Cash	$ 600,000	$ 858,972	$ 632,922	$ 1,324,440	$ 2,211,377	$ 2,700,862
Beginning Cash Balance	0	$ 600,000	$ 1,458,972	$ 2,091,894	$ 3,416,334	$ 5,627,711
Net Change in Cash	$ 600,000	$ 858,972	$ 632,922	$ 1,324,440	$ 2,211,377	$ 2,700,862
Ending Cash Balance	$ 600,000	$ 1,458,972	$ 2,091,894	$ 3,416,334	$ 5,627,711	$ 8,328,573

Financial Ratios Table	Date Ending 2026	Date Ending 2027	Date Ending 2028	Date Ending 2029	Date Ending 2030	Industry Average Ratios
						Input Field / Build Formula
Liquidity Ratios						
Current Ratio	14.97	17.35	20.38	24.66	33.30	1.70
Quick Ratio	12.82	15.09	18.07	22.61	31.08	0.69
Operating Cycle	101.70	101.37	115.07	122.04	124.48	194.50
Leverage Ratios						
Debt/Equity	0.42	0.25	0.19	0.07	0.04	0.74
Times Interest Earned	3.50	13.77	30.30	48.73	67.28	13.80
Asset Management Ratios						
Inventory Turnover	3.85	3.87	3.38	3.17	3.11	2.10
Receivables Turnover	52.14	52.14	52.14	52.14	52.14	8.65
Fixed Asset Turnover	12.08	16.42	18.61	23.15	28.99	5.61
Profitability Ratios						
Gross Profit Margin	68.32	68.21	72.24	73.92	74.46	47.59
Operating Profit Margin	0.07	0.20	0.29	0.37	0.39	10.11
Return on Assets	0.07	0.26	0.36	0.35	0.30	4.30
DuPont Analysis						
Net Profit Margin	0.05	0.18	0.28	0.36	0.38	11.40
Total Asset Turnover	1.53	1.45	1.28	0.97	0.79	0.68
Equity Multiplier	1.50	1.32	1.19	1.12	1.07	1.15
Return on Equity	0.11	0.35	0.42	0.39	0.32	16.78

Appendix 2: Flow Chart

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Appendix 3: Quality

Indicate the Dimensions of Quality on which you will focus.	Why is this dimension important, given your industry & target market?	Identify the Quality Step(s) on the Process Flowchart / Service Blueprint to which this corresponds.
Performance	Customers will expect safe, clean, and great-tasting water. Performance is directly related to the core of our product, as it is related to how effectively and efficiently it removes contaminants. Given the competitive industry, performance is the key differentiating factor in water filters. If performance does not meet the highest standards of both AquaStack and our customers, our product loses all credibility and will quickly be overtaken in the market.	QD 1
Reliability	If our water filter is not reliable, then it simply will not compete in the market. According to Indeed, reliability is the 4th most important factor in customer requirements as of 2025 (Indeed, 2025). If a product were to leak, clog, or fail to filter out harmful elements, then we would have let down our target market. Given that we are targeting people who seek healthy, clean water, they will want a reliable water filter that they can trust and depend on, without worrying about whether their water is being cleaned efficiently and effectively.	QD 2
Special Features	A key factor in our filter will be the three different rings that are all focusing on different types of contaminants found in water. With this, we will be setting our product apart from the generic filters. With the current market being filled with standard filters, we will be able to focus on our new, 3-ring filter that has not yet been seen in the water filtration market. Given our target customers are on the go, they will want a water filter that can filter out different contaminants that are found in different areas around the world, and our 3-ring filter will be able to do that, while the generic filters cannot.	QD 3
Convenience	Since our filter is based around customers who are constantly moving and on the go, convenience will be a key factor in our product. The filter will be easy to put on and take off various faucets. It will also be easy to take out and replace the rings if need be. The convenience of using the actual filter is another big factor in the market, as many products are made to stay on the faucet and not be taken on and off repeatedly.	QD 4

Use the space below to describe any additional Proactive Quality Assurance Plans that are not connected to a specific activity on your Process Flowchart / Service Blueprint.

Our filter is built and designed around giving people clean and healthy water. Alongside clean water, we developed another focus on the environmental impact our water filter will have on the world. With sustainability growing in popularity each year, we decided to make that one of our key focuses. We decided to donate 10 cents of every sale to nonprofit relief programs to help communities worldwide gain access to safe water. This aspect will not only set us apart in the market but will also let our customers know that with every purchase, they too are directly helping communities gain access to clean and safe water.

Describe any reactive quality assurance plans. Include a recovery plan should a customer receive poor quality goods and/or services.

Any complaints that are sent in will be immediately processed and assessed by our customer support team. We will have a clear and concise replacement plan and focus on quick and cooperative communication between our customer support team and the customer.

If you will utilize a quality/process improvement methodology, indicate which:

☐ NA ☐ TQM ☒ Six Sigma ☒ ISO ☐ Benchmarking

☐ Other (specify what):

Note: You will not use all of them; only those with highest relevance.

Provide a specific explanation of how your chosen quality methodology relates to your business and how it will be applied:

Since our target market is both the U.S. and international, the ISO will work best for us to manage and maintain our product, ensuring it is up to date with the latest standards and functioning as intended. We will also utilize the Six Sigma method to ensure our production process operates as efficiently and effectively as possible.

Appendix 4: Target Market/Segmentation

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Segment Name	Size (# of People or Households in Segment)	Growth Projection	Description	Priority level for targeting	Justification for Targeting
B2B (Outdoor recreation retailers)	**69,868,917** units to buy from outdoor recreation retailers (US Census Bureau, 2025)(Skift, 2024)(Statista, 2023, p.8). (83.8% of outdoor enthusiasts in US who travel) (US Census Bureau, 2025).	**8% growth** a year on average according to Primo (Primo Water, 2024).	Outdoor recreation retailers both online and in store locations that are targeted towards outdoor activities such as hiking, backpacking, and camping that also have a pre established loyal customer base such as Sportsman's Guide, Bass Pro Shops, and REI (Statista, 2024).	2	We chose to target this segment because by selling our modular water filter in bulk to other retailers, our product will then be easily accessible to existing customers that go to Sportsman's Guide, Bass Pro Shops, or REI (Statista, 2024). These customers are willing to buy a modular water filter as it already fits into their budget on what they would regularly buy with their disposable income, as many of them are already loyal customers to these outdoor recreation stores (Statista, 2025). This segment is our second priority because the market for water filtration is increasing around 8% annually on average according to past records of Primo Water (Primo Water, 2024), and through the easy access of these retail stores this is how we we will reach most of our customers in the U.S. This allows even more potential for success and growth for the market of our modular water filter and by being easily accessible through outdoor recreation retail stores both in-store and online we will be able to reach more customers and provide more people with access to a reliable and safe water source.
Outdoor Enthusiasts (Hikers, Campers, Travelers, backpackers)	**83,375,796** people in the US who travel (US Census Bureau, 2025) (Skift, 2024) (Statista, 2023, p.8), **13,506,879** who buy directly from AquaStack (16.2% online retail sales) (US Census Bureau, 2025).	**CAGR of 8.8%** from 2023-2031 in relation to the water filtration market and outdoor recreation. (Transparency Market Research, 2023).	Outdoor enthusiasts in the US who participate in camping, hiking, backpacking, and travel with a medium to high average annual income and would be willing to pay $15-$25 for on the go specific water filtration purposes to target various contaminants (Statista, 2025, p. 8).	3	We chose to target this segment because through the use of our modular water filter outdoor enthusiasts such as travelers, hikers, campers, and backpackers will be able to have access to clean and safe water on the go, specified towards various contaminants in the water based on geographic location where water may not be easily accessible, which is perfect for travel offering an efficient and easy solution to access safe water (Statista, 2025, p.15). This is our third priority for targeting because we are mainly going to be selling to other retailers to carry and distribute our water filters throughout the U.S. and international households without access to safe water sources. Our Outdoor Enthusiast market would be U.S. based with customers potentially traveling to areas with more water contaminants or to areas where water is less accessible as a whole. There is also a compound annual growth rate of 8.8% of on the go water filtration usage rom 2023 to 2031 (Transparency Market Research, 2023). These customers would be purchasing our water filter directly from our website and not through outdoor recreation retailers, which is a smaller group of people making this segment our third priority (US Census Bureau, 2025).
Households without access to safely managed water sources (Sub Saharan Africa, Asia Pacific, Latin America)	**447,291,210** people internationally in Sub Saharan Africa, Asia Pacific, and Latin America (World Bank, 2024) (Visual Capitalist, 2023) (Statista, 2023, p.8) (United Nations, 2024) (World Bank, 2024) (Statista, 2025) (Economic Commission for Latin America and the Caribbean, 2024).	**10% growth rate** averaging between China, Japan, South America, and worldwide market for water filtration (WC&P, 2017) (BCC Research, 2019) (Yano Research, 2019) (199IT, 2019).	Households in Sub Saharan Africa, Asia Pacific, and Latin America with a lower to middle ranged income that do not have access to safely managed water sources to use water for drinking, cooking, and daily usage.	1	We chose to target this segment because the are many households in Sub Saharan Africa, Asia Pacific, and Latin America that use tap water for drinking, cooking, and showering where their tap water contains many contaminants and is not coming from a safely managed water source where water filtration would provide them with different benefits including health and taste while incorporating affordability (UNICEF, 2023) (Rosenburg, 2025). This is our first priority segment to target so we can provide access to safe water to many households across the world, specifically in areas such as these that are in need of a safe water source to use in their everyday lives. Our modular water filter is both affordable and efficient making it accessible to a large amount of people (Statista, 2024). This market is expected to grow on average 10% annually, expanding brand awareness of our water filter within the market (WC&P, 2017) (BCC Research, 2019) (Yano Research, 2019) (199IT, 2019). We also have a PR element to our company where we will give back 10 cents for each sale we make to UNICEF, which can provide incentive especially to Sub Saharan Africa, Asia Pacific, and Latin America to buy our product to give back to areas in need with the help of UNICEF.

Appendix 5: Market Quantification

AquaStack
A modular water filter.

Year	Tot Mkt Potential (# Customers)*	Mkt Growth Projection**	Market Share***	Product	Channel	Annual Unit Sales	Unit Price or Weighted ASP	Annual $ Revenue
Year 1	304,300,625	8.30%	0.04347%	Main filter	Channel 1 (e.g. direct)	132,284	$20.00	$2,645,682
	45,699,375	7%	0.00653%	Main filter	Channel 2 (e.g. retail)	2,983	$15.00	$44,752
	156,497,464	8%	0.01739%	Replacement	Channel 1 (e.g. direct)	27,213	$15.00	$408,191
	23,502,535.7	7%	0.00261%	Replacement	Channel 2 (e.g. retail)	614	$10.00	$6,137
	530,000,000		0.0700%	Totals		163,094		$3,104,763
Year 2	329557576.9	9.20%	0.0468%	Main filter	Channel 1 (e.g. direct)	154,363	$20.00	$3,087,252
	48898331.25	7.50%	0.0082%	Main filter	Channel 2 (e.g. retail)	3,990	$15.00	$59,856
	156524676.7	9%	0.0336%	Replacement	Channel 1 (e.g. direct)	52,595	$15.00	$788,919
	25147713.2	7.50%	0.0054%	Replacement	Channel 2 (e.g. retail)	1,358	$10.00	$13,576
	560128298.1		0.0940%	Totals		212,305		$3,949,603
Year 3	359876873.9	11%	0.05148%	Main filter	Channel 1 (e.g. direct)	185,266	$20.00	$3,705,326
	52565706.09	8%	0.00752%	Main filter	Channel 2 (e.g. retail)	3,953	$15.00	$59,290
	170611897.6	10%	0.06560%	Replacement	Channel 1 (e.g. direct)	111,930	$15.00	$1,678,944
	27033791.69	8%	0.010395%	Replacement	Channel 2 (e.g. retail)	2,810	$10.00	$28,102
	610088269.4		0.13500%	Totals		303,959		$5,471,662
Year 4	399463330.1	10.50%	0.05429%	Main filter	Channel 1 (e.g. direct)	216,849	$20.00	$4,336,981
	56770962.58	7.50%	0.01%	Main filter	Channel 2 (e.g. retail)	4,380	$15.00	$65,697
	187673087.4	11%	0.06750%	Replacement	Channel 1 (e.g. direct)	126,678	$15.00	$1,900,165
	29196495.02	7.50%	0.01050%	Replacement	Channel 2 (e.g. retail)	3,066	$10.00	$30,659
	673103875.1		0.14000%	Totals		350,972		$6,333,502
Year 5	441406979.7	10%	0.057105%	Main filter	Channel 1 (e.g. direct)	252,064	$20.00	$5,041,284
	61028784.77	7%	0.007895%	Main filter	Channel 2 (e.g. retail)	4,818	$15.00	$72,276
	208317127	11%	0.070110%	Replacement	Channel 1 (e.g. direct)	146,051	$15.00	$2,190,765
	31386232.15	7%	0.009890%	Replacement	Channel 2 (e.g. retail)	3,104	$10.00	$31,041
	742139123.7		0.145000%	Totals		406,038		$7,335,367

Fcst by month	Units	Revenue ($)
Jan '26	3262	$62,095
Feb	4893	$93,143
Mar	6524	$124,191
Apr	8155	$155,238
May	11417	$217,333
Jun	13048	$248,381
Jul	16309	$310,476
Aug	19571	$372,572
Sep	21202	$403,619
Oct	22833	$434,667
Nov	17940	$341,524
Dec	17940	$341,524

Appendix 6: Marketing Mix

AquaStack
A modular water filter.

Exhibit #4:
Marketing Mix

Product/Service Branding

AquaStack is a modular water filter designed to target a variety of contaminants through easily interchangeable rings, to create a safe water source to have access to clean water both at home and on the go.
Branding strategies: We brand AquaStack off of the fact that it's customizable and can be personalized to what you need out of your water. We made it easy and simple to travel with which is an advantage our competitors do not have.
Slogan: "Clean water, one layer at a time" PLC in market: Growth

Distribution/Location Strategy

Product Teams: Describe and defend your distribution strategy; We plan to sell AquaStack to primarily directly to the consumer through our website, and we will be selling our product through retail outdoor store in the US.
Service Teams: Manufacturing: Austin, Texas
Corporate HQ: Austin, Texas

Promotional Strategy- Main Filter

	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030
Total IMC Budget:	$443,996.1	$456,430.42	$470,675.82	$462,690.70	$434,773.00
Advertising Exp:	$430,469.4	$440,595.12	$451,753.92	$440,567.80	$409,084.80
Sales Promo Exp:	$0.00	$0.00	$0.00	$0.00	$0.00
PR Exp:	$13,526.70	$15,835.30	$18,921.90	$22,122.90	$25,688.20
Other Promo Exp:	$0.00	$0.00	$0.00	$0.00	$0.00

We are choosing to advertise our product heavily in the beginning and slowly decrease expenses each year. We are calculating this by expensing 16%-8% from the annual revenue each year. We chose to only do sales promotion for our replacement sales, so for the product itself we will not be doing any sales promotion expense. For PR expenses, we decided to donate 10 cents to U.N.I.C.E.F. for every purchase.

# of Salespeople:	1	1	2	2	3
Compensation Method:	$80,000.00	$80,000.00	$160,000.00	$160,000.00	$240,000.00

Each Sales Representative is expected to generate $800,000 in annual revenue. To support this, we plan to provide a base salary of $40,000 plus a 5% commission on sales, allowing each representative to earn about $80,000 per year.

Promotional Strategy- Replacements (in thousands of $ - verify $ are correct)

	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030
Total IMC Budget:	$69,075.18	$117,744.60	$253,300.52	$206,056.80	$32,659.98
Advertising Exp:	$66,292.48	$112,349.30	$204,845.52	$193,082.40	$17,744.48
Sales Promo Exp:	$0.00	$0.00	$36,981.00	$0.00	$0.00
PR Exp:	$2,782.70	$5,395.30	$11,474.00	$12,974.40	$14,915.50
Other Promo Exp:					

Pricing- Main Filter

	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030
Unit Variable Cost:	$2.78	$2.78	$2.78	$2.78	$2.78
Wholesale Price:	$15	$15	$15	$15	$15
Retail Price:	$20	$20	$20	$20	$20

Justify your pricing strategy and price point(s)...illustrate price calculation from a cost & market basis.:
When researching outdoor enthusiests, outdoor retail stores, and households without access to safely managed water, we calculated that the best and most effective price would be $15-$25. We decided to make the main faucet filter $20. We then broke down the supplies used to make this main filter and added them up to find the unit varible cost.

Pricing- Replacements

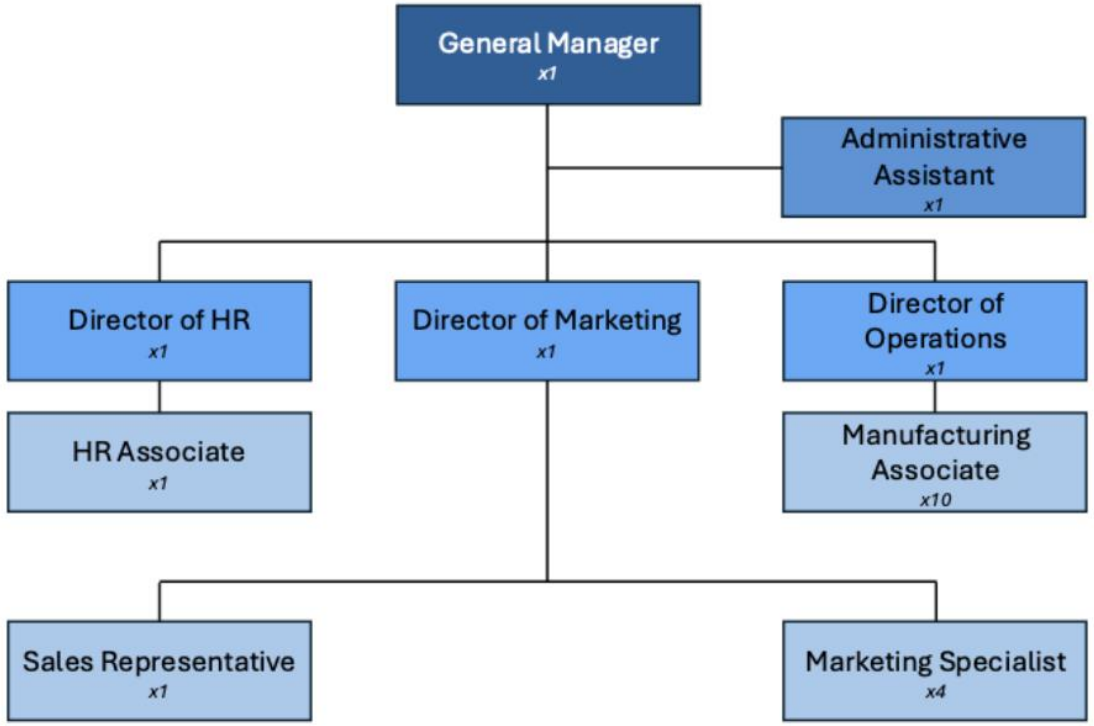
	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030
Unit Variable Cost:	$2.92	$2.92	$2.92	$2.92	$2.92
Wholesale Price:	$10.00	$10.00	$10.00	$10.00	$10.00
Retail Price:	$15.00	$15.00	$15.00	$15.00	$15.00

Appendix 7: Pay & Motivation

Team Name: AquaStack		YEAR 2		Section: 2		Team: 9		Date (1/1/2027)		Note: update numbers, check formulae and research your own State or Country					
(if wage is used for a position, do the calculation of yearly pay based on hourly wage and total hours worked)															
Compensation							Mandatory Payroll Deductions				Benefits				
Position (Salary/Wage - W) (Full-time Assumed, Part-time - PT %)	Salary or Wage for position)	Bonus or Commission	# for position	Projected End of Year 2 Salary or Wage **including** bonus/comm. Each	Projected End of Year 2 Salary or Wage **including** bonus/comm. all positions	FICA	FUTA*	SUTA	WC	Mandatory Deductions - Total	Benefits - Health Cost	Benefits - Retirement Cost	Benefits - Any other Benefit Cost	Benefits - Total	Total Cost per Employee	Total Cost for All Employees
General Manager	110,000	0	1	110000	110000	9405	42	216	1100	10763	6396	6600	0	12,996	133,759	**133,759**
Administrative Assistant	90,000	0	1	90000	90000	6885	42	216	900	8043	6396	5400	0	11,796	109,839	**109,839**
Director of HR	80,000	5000	1	85000	85000	6503	42	216	850	7611	6396	5100	0	11,496	104,107	**104,107**
Director of Marketing	80,000	5000	1	85000	85000	6503	42	216	850	7611	6396	5100	0	11,496	104,107	**104,107**
Director of Operations	80,000	5000	1	85000	85000	6503	42	216	850	7611	6396	5100	0	11,496	104,107	**104,107**
HR Associate	50,000	0	1	50000	50000	3825	42	216	500	4583	6396	3000	0	9,396	63,979	**63,979**
Marketing Specialist	50,000	0	4	50000	200000	15300	168	864	2000	18332	25584	12000	0	37,584	63,979	**255,916**
Sales Representative	40,000	40,000	1	80000	80000	6120	42	216	800	7178	6396	4800	0	11,196	98,374	**98,374**
Manufacturing Associate	50,000	0	10	45000	500000	38250	420	2160	5000	45830	63960	48000	0	111,960	65,779	**657,790**
Totals	630,000		21	680000	785,000	61,043	882	4,536	7,850	71,731	70,356	47,100	0	229,416	848,029	1,631,977

b) **Motivation Table**- At AquaStack, employee success and well-being are our top priorities. We will support individual needs, whether that means leaving early for a child's event or enjoying a fully paid weekend retreat. Each month, we will recognize an Employee of the Month and celebrate all team members with an appreciation event. Around major holidays, we will host work parties to reduce stress, encourage bonding, and give employees something to look forward to.

Appendix 8: Org Structure



We will begin operations with one General Manager, one Administrative Assistant, one Director of Human Resources, one Director of Marketing, and one Director of Operations. These leadership roles are expected to remain constant over time, with changes only if performance issues require replacement(firing/hiring).

Our Human Resources team will start with one HR Associate, adding one additional associate in Year 3 and another in Year 5 to support growth. Sales will begin with one Sales Representative, adding an additional representative in Year 3 and Year 5 as demand increases.

Marketing will launch with four Specialists, each responsible for a major geographic region: the United States, Sub-Saharan Africa, Asia-Pacific, and Latin America.

Manufacturing will start with eight Associates to operate Year 1 machinery. In Year 2, as production expands and we purchase additional machines, we will add two more Associates; in Year 5, we will add one additional Associate to support increased manufacturing and packaging needs.